

saturation and helps get you a more reliable and consistent measurement. If you're trying to figure out which sensor is which, then the green light is for the heart rate sensor, the red light is for the SpO2 sensor and there's another green light for the PPG sensor. The SpO2 sensor is sandwiched between the two other sensors. We could see the green lights emanating from the ring but not once could we spot the red lights.

With the hardware out of the way, let's get down to the software and the way all the data collected by the sensors is shown to you. Since the Luna Ring is a... well, ring, there is no display or screen to show you any of the data so you have to use the Luna Ring app which although had some bugs in the beginning, now works just fine. It's a pretty simple app and every time you open it, the app syncs with the ring to update the readings with the new information. It's quite seamless for the most part and everything you need to check out at a glance is neatly laid out.

It does have a couple of problems though. For example, if you have not opened the app in the last few hours, the app does not know the status of the ring and if in that time the ring has low battery and then is completely drained of battery, you would never know. The app would just not be able to sync with the ring and you would be left wondering why because the battery indicator on the app still shows the previous battery reading which might have been quite a few hours ago. It was a bit nerve-wracking in the beginning, but now after having established a routine for charging the ring, the issue can be worked around.

Another major gripe I have with the app is that it is not at all customisable. You are shown what it wants to show, in places it wants to show it. Oh, and the worst part is that you cannot initiate a measurement on the spot, except if you want to measure the heart rate. So you're out of luck if you want a reading of your body temperature or SpO2 at that moment. The app seems to have a very Apple way of doing things, where it seems like the user is on a need-to-know basis. Thankfully though, you can



connect Google Fit with the Luna Ring app and both can work in conjunction to give you more accurate measurements. Using Google Fit, you can also gamify your fitness and health tracking while competing with friends. But you will need a different app for that.

When it comes to battery life, Noise claims up to five days of use on a single charge, but realistically it's more like three days. Noise also claims a full charge time of 90 to 120 minutes which is a bit long and personally I tend to forget it if I have left it aside for so long. Smart rings such as the Samsung Galaxy Ring, Ultrahuman Ring, Oura, etc. have about a 14-24 mAh battery and the Noise Luna Ring will also have something around the same capacity considering that the form factor would only allow as much. Noise does not mention the battery capacity anywhere. And most other rings also take a similar amount of time to charge their batteries. The best way I found to maximise usability was a 15 to 20-minute charge every day. That way you are nice and topped up most of the time and you are also getting the most tracking done.

Verdict - Tracking the trek to Mt. Doom

Overall, the Noise Luna Ring seems to have done what it set out to do. Add a whole new genre of fitness trackers to the mainstream Indian market. Yes, we know there have been others like this in the past and since its launch there have been some more from competing brands. But this one is a bit special. What makes it special is its size-to-feature ratio. There are other rings that provide the same or more features, but they also add a bit of bulk. There are other rings that are just as slim, but miss out on a few features that the Luna Ring sports. The Luna Ring seems to have hit the sweet spot when it comes to the size-to-feature ratio.

BUT. And there is a big but to consider, which is the price. Coming in at an eye-watering Rs. 19,999 the Luna Ring is definitely not for the masses. For a small fraction of the price, you can get yourself a fitness tracker from many other reputable brands with more sensors, a display, vibration alerts, more battery life, and did we say more sensors? And it can tell you the time as well.

For about half the price you can get yourself a decked-out smartwatch. Like the Amazfit T-Rex Pro which again would have a 40-46 mm display, potentially way better battery life, way more sensors, Bluetooth calling, built-in GPS, more tracking parameters and who can forget, multiple watch faces to tell the time. If you are an iPhone user, the Apple Watch SE (2nd Gen) which is regularly on sale for under Rs 25,000, is a great buy. And for Android users who want a smartwatch from a more well-known brand, there is the Samsung Galaxy Watch series ranging from the Watch 4 to Watch 6. Take your pick for whichever one falls within your budget.

So if you have loads of cash to spare and want a fitness tracker that is limited in its capabilities but makes for a fine conversation starter, then this is the one for you. But if you are looking for a good deal and have the same amount to spare, a smartwatch would give you a way bigger bang for your buck. **👎**